

France — Residence Routes

Talent cards and the long-stay visitor permit. France has no golden visa.

There is no French residency-by-investment programme.

The official register of French residence permits contains no investor card. Any "France investment programme" offered at a fixed price with a promised return is a private financial product, not a government route. The four routes below are real permits with published criteria.

Talent card — direct economic investment

Investment	€300,000 in tangible or intangible fixed assets in France
Structure	Held personally, or via a company in which you hold at least 30% of the capital
Also required	An undertaking to create or preserve employment in France
Card	Up to 4 years, renewable; carries the right to work

No guaranteed return. This is equity in a business and carries ordinary commercial risk.

Talent card — business creation

Financing	At least €30,000 behind the project; own funds or borrowed
Profile	Master's-level qualification, or 5 years' experience at a comparable level
Living costs	Personal resources at the annual gross SMIC, €22,404.20
Card	Up to 4 years, renewable

The €30,000 is an admissibility floor. The decision turns on whether the project is real and serious.

Talent card — innovative economic project

Investment	No minimum specified
The gate	Project recognised as innovative by the ministry responsible for the economy
Living costs	Personal resources at the annual gross SMIC, €22,404.20
Card	Up to 4 years, renewable

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Visitor permit, family rights and the route to citizenship

Long-stay visitor card

Resources	€1,477.93 net per month for a single person (€17,735.19 a year)
Work	Prohibited — employment, trading, self-employment and liberal professions
Card	1 year, renewable; €350 first issue, €250 renewal
Renewal	Filed online 4 to 2 months before expiry; €180 if late

Naturalisation separately requires income from professional integration. Whether visitor years count towards the five is not stated either way in official guidance.

Family

Talent routes	Spouse and minor children receive a talent-famille card — no family reunification procedure
Visitor route	Family members need their own basis

Citizenship

Residence	5 years (2 years for holders of a French higher-education diploma after 2 years' study)
Language	French at B2, in force since 1 January 2026
Civics exam	40 questions, pass mark 32, maximum 45 minutes
Also required	Valid permit, centre of interests in France, stable sufficient income
Fee	€255